

Standard Operating Procedure Horizontal Band Saw

Horizontal Band Saw

A Horizontal Band saw is useful for cutting stock into smaller pieces. The blade runs around wheels going across the machine, allowing the metal be cut where the blade is traveling across the bench. The Horizontal Band Saw is a rough cutting tool; it is not intended for finished cuts.

Personal Protective Equipment					
 **Tie Back Hair & Secure Loose Items**	 **Closed Toe Shoes**	 **Eye/Face Protection**	 **Hearing Protection**	 **Protective Clothing**	 **No Gloves Advised**
Tie back long hair and secure loose clothing that could get caught in rotating parts. Remove rings and other jewelry.	Appropriate enclosed footwear should be worn.	Wear ANSI Z87.1-compliant safety goggles to protect eyes. Face shields may be necessary to protect from dust, shards, and debris.	Hearing protection should be worn when noise levels are excessive.	Close-fitting or protective clothing, such as an apron, is encouraged.	Gloves can get caught in rotating parts. Use push sticks or boards and follow the "4 inch" rule to keep hands away from harm.

Potential Hazards

- Be aware of the following potential hazards when working with Horizontal Band saws:
  - **Mechanical:** points of operation, pinch points, shear points, power transmission points
  - **Operational:** heat, dust/chips/shards, noise, unstable loads/stocks
  - **Chemical:** coolants, cleaning solvents
  - **Electrical/Energy Sources:** exposed wiring, malfunctioning equipment, unexpected start up/shut down

Before Use

- Know the location of start and stop switches or buttons, and keep the Horizontal Band saw area free of tools and other materials.
- Do not cut thin wall tube on this machine. Under 1/8th" wall not permitted.



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- Report any unsafe conditions observed on the band saw or stock being worked on to the shop supervisor.
- Ensure that machine guards are in place and recommended personal protective equipment is worn.
- Make sure that the stock is no shorter than 4 inches. Stock shorter than 4 inches is to not to be cut in this saw unless permission from the Shop Super Supervisor or On Duty SRA is granted with proper fixturing.
- Ensure the blade is properly adjusted prior to turning on the machine.
- Check coolant level and make sure that the pump is fully submerged.
    - See SRA for assistance adding coolant.
- DO NOT stand to the right side of the machine. In case of blade splitting.

During Use

- Concentrate on the task at hand; avoid distractions. Most injuries occur when the operator is not paying full attention to what they are doing.
- Make sure the Stock is clamped properly by sliding the soft jaw closed on the stock and then taking the vice handle and spinning it fully counter-clockwise first followed by clockwise to tighten the vice to stock.
- Adjust the left blade guard to as close to the soft clamp prior to starting the machine.
- Allow the saw to reach full set speed prior to cutting stock.
- Slowly ease the saw down to allow full blade engagement before the full weight of the blade is cutting the stock.
- Make sure that the left lower guard does not inhibit the actuation of the “Off” switch.



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After Use

- Wait for the saw blade to completely stop on its own- do not attempt to use your hands to stop it from moving.
- Spin the Vice Handle counterclockwise until it no longer spins.
- When losing the stock form the vise take care to not have the stock fall on the floor.
- Stock will be sharp around the cut face.
- Sweep or use a shop vacuum to collect any debris that resulted from cutting on the floor or other surfaces. Avoid cleaning with compressed air to prevent injury.
- Store stock materials in a neat and secured manner; do not accumulate excess combustibles. Keep aisles and exits clear.
- Wash hands and exposed skin thoroughly after completing work and before leaving the shop area.

Emergency Equipment and Procedures

- Report all incidents to the shop supervisor, including injuries, equipment damage, and near misses.
- Know the location of the nearest emergency equipment and items, such as the emergency stop/shut-off for the specific machine, eye wash, first aid kit, fire extinguishers, fire alarm pull stations, and emergency exits.

